



Bone Grafting

Purpose: Placement of bone or bone substitute to build up jawbone for future dental implants.

First 24 Hours:

- Avoid disturbing the graft site with your tongue, fingers, or food.
- Do not rinse, spit, or use a straw.
- Keep head elevated while resting.

Pain & Swelling:

- Mild to moderate discomfort is normal; take prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs to the cheek for 20 minutes on/off for the first 6–8 hours.

Bleeding:

- Slight bleeding or pink saliva is normal for 24–48 hours.
- Apply firm pressure with gauze if bleeding increases.

Oral Hygiene:

- Avoid brushing directly over the graft site for 1 week.
- Use antimicrobial mouth rinse if prescribed.
- Brush and floss other areas normally.

Diet:

- Soft foods for several days.
- Avoid seeds, nuts, chips, or foods that could get lodged in the surgical site.

Follow-Up:

- Graft material may appear as small granules in the mouth — this is normal early in healing.
- Contact the office if you experience increasing pain, swelling, or discharge from the site.